

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager, BNPL Merchants.*

Positioning, ten-plus years shipping merchant and consumer products in fintech, payments and regulated B2B2C platforms, the exact intersection this role sits at.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY EDISON SMART®

BNPL is one of the few fintech categories where the product decision layer genuinely sits between two distinct customers, the merchant who integrates and the consumer who pays, and getting that balance right is a hard, interesting problem. The specific focus on activation, checkout integration and repeat usage maps directly to the kind of funnel-driven, cross-functional work I find most compelling: not just shipping features, but moving the metric that proves the feature was worth building. The fact that this is a period of deliberate team expansion, not a backfill, tells me the product organisation is investing in genuine ownership rather than coordination. *That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo specs and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, accelerated delivery cycles
- **Cursor**, in-editor refactoring and review
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframes and prototypes
- **GPT**, discovery synthesis and stakeholder documents
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, strategy decks and stakeholder communication

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD via Jenkins and GitLab, Dagster, dbt, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built zero-to-one as a solo founder.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protects both sides of the market until commitment is reached.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, removing friction from the hire funnel entirely.
 - LLM agents across the funnel so one person runs the full day-to-day operation.
 - Demonstrates exactly the kind of merchant-and-consumer balance this role demands: every product decision affects both sides simultaneously.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT EDISON SMART®

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow merchant onboarding calls and merchant success interactions, map the current activation and checkout integration funnel end to end, and identify where merchants drop or stall before their first live transaction.

WEEK 2

Instrument, slice, prioritise.

Pull cohort and funnel data to quantify the friction points surfaced in week one, run structured conversations with Commercial and Merchant Success, and draft a first version of the opportunity backlog ranked by activation and retention impact.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, close loops.

Align the squad around the top priority, define success metrics before building starts, and drive the first delivery cycle through to a measurable outcome with a post-ship review to confirm the metric moved.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Senior Product Manager, BNPL Merchants role. My background spans over thirteen years of product ownership across fintech, payments, regulated B2B platforms and public-sector analytics, and the specific problem this role is asking someone to solve, making it easier for merchants to activate, integrate and grow with a BNPL proposition while keeping the consumer checkout experience front of mind, is a problem I find genuinely compelling and am well-positioned to take on.

My most directly relevant experience comes from two directions. As founder and product owner of Kvitt Payment Solutions, I built a mobile group-based P2P payments product from zero through to acquisition, operating inside the girocard ecosystem at Sparkasse. That experience gave me a ground-level understanding of how payment flows, consumer trust and merchant or partner incentives interact, and how quickly an integration decision in one layer creates friction or opportunity in another. More recently, at EMIL Group I owned a B2B SaaS insurance platform serving insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters: a genuinely B2B2C structure where the platform customer and the end user are distinct people with distinct needs. I restructured an eighteen-person delivery organisation into three focused squads, shipped the Claims Center from concept to production, and reduced time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week. The mechanics, stakeholder triangulation across commercial, technical and success functions, funnel analysis, cross-functional squad ownership, transfer directly.

On the analytical side: at the Federal Employment Agency I used Dagster, dbt and PostgreSQL to drive a data platform that eliminated roughly 75% of manual effort per data update cycle. At Rohde & Schwarz I instrumented competing product workflows with real usage data and used the findings to redirect the entire product strategy, the result was a 200% increase in pipeline runs. I mention these not as infrastructure credentials but as evidence that I reach for data before I reach for opinion, and that I know how to translate funnel and cohort findings into prioritisation decisions the squad can act on.

The B2B2C nature of the BNPL merchant product is something I take seriously rather than treat as a footnote. Every decision in the merchant activation or integration flow has a

downstream effect on the consumer checkout experience, and the product manager who loses sight of that creates invisible problems that show up later as churn or conversion drop. My experience building on both sides of two-sided markets, at Kvitt on the consumer payment side, at EMIL and CLINET on the business platform side, means I hold both perspectives simultaneously rather than defaulting to whichever is louder in the room.

I am actively targeting roles in the UAE and am ready to relocate to Dubai without delay. I am available at four weeks' notice and require no visa sponsorship within the EU; for the UAE I am prepared to handle relocation independently.

I would be glad to discuss the role in more detail at your convenience.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Senior Product Manager with thirteen years of product ownership across fintech, payments, regulated B2B2C platforms and public-sector data. I run continuous discovery, build evidence-based roadmaps, and lead cross-functional squads, Commercial, Engineering, Design and Merchant Success, from problem definition through to measurable delivery. Payment flow and platform integration are areas I have shipped production work in, not just advised on.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support, funnel and cohort analysis, KPI definition.

Payment and Fintech: payment flow and PSP integration product design, P2P consumer payment UX, B2B2C platform ownership, merchant activation and onboarding funnel design, girocard ecosystem, GDPR.

Product Ownership and Agile Delivery: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, cohort analysis, KPI definition, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, stakeholder management, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, squad restructuring, conflict resolution.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, REST APIs, Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes; usage instrumentation redirected strategy and drove a 200% increase in pipeline runs across a 15-person cross-functional squad. Stack: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Dagster, Python, Scrum.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Introduced Dagster and dbt to a national labour-market data platform, saving 75% of time per data update; migrated a bare-metal system to containers while carrying a full UI relaunch in parallel. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023-2023

Cut an undeliverable roadmap to its top 10% by impact; user acceptance rose more than fivefold. Integrated CGM into hospital KIS workflows, reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022-2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three focused squads, reversing near-total attrition to a single departure. Shipped the Claims Center from zero to production; reduced new-product time-to-market from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL PAYMENTS AND POS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · SECURE DATA
PLATFORM 2021-2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B
2019-2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and approximately 20,000 employees; still in production.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK
2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION B2B
MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero-to-one two-sided marketplace; LLM agents across the full funnel; anonymity-until-payment model; funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer enterprise encryption product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the Board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRITECH
2018-2021

Took a nanotechnology fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH PAYMENTS
2013-2018

Built a mobile group-based P2P payments product from zero to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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